# EGGLESS NUTELLA DOUBLE CHOCOLATE CHUNK COOKIES

Thick bakery-style cookies · toasted-butter flavour · molten hazelnut-chocolate centre

| Yield | Portion size | Oven | Chill |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12 large cookies | 85–90 g dough + filling | 175°C conventional | 8–12 hours |

## Recipe character

A deeply chocolatey, thick cookie with a gently crisp edge, a soft centre and a sealed Nutella filling. Browned butter adds toasted dairy notes; Dutch-process cocoa deepens the chocolate profile; milk powder supports browning and a rounded bakery flavour. The filling is stabilised with dark couverture so it remains creamy when warm without becoming runny.

**Important: This is a completely eggless formula. Use thick, unsweetened Greek yoghurt and weigh all ingredients. For the most reliable result, freeze the filling portions until firm and chill the shaped dough overnight.**

## Ingredients

### A. Nutella-centred filling

| Ingredient | Weight | Purpose / note |
|---|---|---|
| Nutella | 120 g | Hazelnut-cocoa centre |
| Dark couverture chocolate | 25 g | Sets the filling when chilled |
| Fine sea salt | 0.3 g | Balances sweetness |

### B. Cookie dough

| Ingredient | Weight | Ingredient | Weight |
|---|---|---|---|
| Unsalted butter | 125 g | Plain flour | 190 g |
| Nutella | 150 g | Dutch-process cocoa | 28 g |
| Light brown sugar | 105 g | Cornflour | 12 g |
| Caster sugar | 45 g | Skimmed milk powder | 12 g |
| Thick Greek yoghurt | 45 g | Bicarbonate of soda | 2.5 g |
| Vanilla bean paste | 5 g | Baking powder | 1.5 g |

| Ingredient | Weight | Ingredient | Weight |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dark couverture chunks, 55–65% | 110 g | Fine sea salt | 2.5 g |
| Milk couverture chunks | 65 g | Espresso powder | 1 g |
| Toasted hazelnuts, chopped | 35 g | Extra dark chocolate for topping | 30 g |

## Equipment

Digital scale; small heavy-based saucepan; heatproof bowl; balloon whisk; fine-mesh sieve; silicone spatula; baking trays; baking parchment; small scoop or kitchen scale; flat tray for freezing filling; refrigerator; oven thermometer (recommended). No stand mixer is required.

## Method

**1. Make the Nutella filling.** Melt the 25 g dark couverture gently over a bain-marie or in short microwave bursts, stirring until smooth. Add the Nutella and salt. Stir until fully combined and glossy. Do not overheat; the mixture should be fluid enough to portion but not hot.

**2. Portion and freeze.** Weigh the filling into 12 portions of approximately 12 g each. Shape each into a flat disc, about 3–4 cm wide. Place on parchment and freeze for 1–2 hours, or until firm all the way through. Keep frozen until assembly.

**3. Brown the butter.** Place the butter in a light-coloured saucepan over medium heat. Melt, then continue cooking, swirling the pan. The butter will foam; watch the milk solids at the base. When they turn golden amber and smell nutty, immediately pour all the butter and browned solids into a heatproof bowl. Do not discard the solids.

**4. Cool the butter.** Allow the browned butter to cool until thick but still soft, approximately 25–30°C. It should not be hot or fully solid. This prevents it from excessively warming the Nutella and helps the dough hold its structure.

**5. Combine the wet ingredients.** Whisk the 150 g Nutella into the cooled browned butter until uniform. Add the light brown sugar and caster sugar and whisk until evenly moistened. Add Greek yoghurt and vanilla; whisk until smooth. The mixture may look slightly thick and glossy.

**6. Prepare the dry ingredients.** In a separate bowl, whisk together plain flour, cocoa, cornflour, milk powder, bicarbonate of soda, baking powder, fine sea salt and espresso powder. Sift to remove cocoa lumps and distribute the raising agents evenly.

**7. Form the dough.** Add the dry mixture to the wet mixture in two additions. Use a silicone spatula to fold, scraping the base and sides of the bowl. Stop as soon as no dry flour remains. Do not beat or overmix; excessive mixing can make the cookies firm.

**8. Add inclusions.** Fold in the dark couverture chunks, milk couverture chunks and toasted chopped hazelnuts. Reserve the extra 30 g dark chocolate for the tops. Distribute the inclusions evenly without crushing them.

**9. Portion the dough.** Divide into 12 portions of approximately 85–90 g each. If the dough is very soft, refrigerate it for 15–20 minutes before shaping. Flatten one portion into a thick disc in your palm.

**10. Enclose the filling.** Place one frozen Nutella disc in the centre. Bring the dough up around it and pinch the seams together firmly. Check that no filling is exposed. Roll gently into a ball, then shape it into a slightly tall mound rather than a flat puck. Repeat with the remaining portions.

**11. Top and chill.** Press a few reserved dark chocolate chunks onto the tops, keeping the seams underneath. Arrange the portions on a tray with space between them. Cover and refrigerate for 8–12 hours. This rest hydrates the flour, firms the fat and improves flavour and spread control.

**12. Preheat the oven.** Heat a conventional oven to 175°C (or 165°C fan). Use an oven thermometer if available. Line a cool, light-coloured baking tray with parchment. Bake one tray at a time for the most even result.

**13. Bake.** Arrange chilled dough portions well apart, usually 5–6 per standard tray. Bake for approximately 12–15 minutes. The edges should look set, while the centres remain slightly soft and appear a little underdone. Avoid waiting for the centres to become firm in the oven; carry-over heat continues cooking them.

**14. Shape and rest.** Immediately after baking, if desired, use a large round cutter to gently nudge the edges into a neat circle without compressing the centre. Rest on the tray for 15 minutes before transferring to a rack. The cookies are fragile while hot.

**15. Serve.** Serve warm for a soft centre and creamy Nutella filling. For the clearest molten-centre effect, break one cookie open after a short rest. Finish with a very small pinch of flaky sea salt if desired.

## Critical process controls

| Control point | Target / cue | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Browned butter | Golden-amber milk solids; nutty aroma; include all solids | Develops flavour; dark solids can burn quickly |
| Butter temperature | About 25–30°C; thick but soft | Prevents greasy, overly loose dough |
| Filling | 12 firm frozen discs, about 12 g each | Makes sealing easier and limits leakage |
| Dough mixing | Fold only until flour disappears | Avoids a tough cookie texture |
| Chilling | 8–12 hours, covered | Controls spread and improves flavour |
| Bake endpoint | Set edges; soft, slightly underdone centres | Preserves a tender centre after carry-over baking |

## Troubleshooting

**Cookies spread too much:** Butter or dough may have been too warm, or the dough was insufficiently chilled. Chill shaped portions overnight; confirm the oven is fully preheated and use a cool, lined tray.

**Filling leaks out:** The filling discs may not have been frozen firm, or the dough seam was not completely sealed. Keep filling frozen and ensure a continuous dough layer surrounds it.

**Cookies are dry or cakey:** They may have been overbaked, overmixed or measured with too much flour. Weigh ingredients and remove the cookies while the centres are still soft.

**Centres remain raw and greasy:** The portions may be too large, too cold for the chosen bake time, or the oven temperature inaccurate. Verify oven temperature and bake until the edges are set; adjust time in 1-minute increments.

**Chocolate tastes harsh:** Use couverture with a balanced cocoa profile and avoid scorching the browned butter. Espresso powder should remain at the stated small quantity.

## Storage and service

**Unbaked portions:** Keep covered in the refrigerator for up to 24 hours after the overnight rest. For longer storage, freeze the shaped portions on a tray until solid, then transfer to an airtight container. Bake from frozen at the same temperature, allowing a few extra minutes and checking the centre and edges.
**Baked cookies:** Store fully cooled cookies in an airtight container at room temperature for up to 3 days. Rewarm briefly in a low oven to soften the chocolate; avoid overheating, which can cause the filling to become excessively hot.
**Allergen note:** Contains wheat/gluten, milk and hazelnuts. Check couverture, cocoa and Nutella labels for cross-contact and ingredient declarations.

## Chef’s quality standard

**A successful cookie should have a defined, thick profile; a lightly crisp, irregular edge; a soft, fudgy chocolate crumb; visible couverture pieces; and a distinct Nutella centre that remains enclosed until the cookie is broken. The filling should be creamy when warm, not watery. Allow the cookie to rest briefly before breaking so the crumb has enough structure to hold the centre.**

THE CURLY CHEF · Crafted with patience, precision and a little chocolate indulgence.